

Chapter 193 - Part 1

Extra 15-1

Many years ago, someone asked Chen Mian a question: If today were the end of the world, what would you do?

After thinking, Chen Mian answered in a very soft voice: "The world can perish now."

At that time, Chen Mian was sitting on a rock at the mountaintop, the morning sun slowly rising from behind the mountain.

In the distant sky, it painted orange-pink rays of light, like fireworks blooming in the night, breathtakingly beautiful.

But Chen Mian's gaze fell on the person beside her.

The girl sitting beside Chen Mian had her hair cascading down, the morning sun's light falling on her face, gentle and beautiful.

Her lip color was somewhat pale, her figure slender.

That day she softly hummed a song.

"A lone bird flies into the Milky Way, boarding a ship

Someone raises the sail

Someone stops at the other shore"

Her voice was clear, her fair hand keeping time on her knee.

Unhurried and unrushed, steady and measured.

She said: "We might all be lone birds."

Back then, at just over ten years old, eyes could serve as cameras, capturing all the beauty within their frames.

So their eyes sparkled brightly.

She asked Chen Mian, "Why can the world perish now?"

Chen Mian remained silent.

Actually, the answer was on the tip of her tongue at that moment, but she didn't dare say it because the person beside her was too beautiful.

As if all negative words were unworthy of her who was shining at that moment.

Later, Chen Mian thought countless times—if only the world had perished at that moment.

Because she always wanted time to stop at the most beautiful moment.

That way, the world would be beautiful.

And so would you and I.

Chen Mian got up at seven in the morning.

For someone used to staying up late, getting up at this time was very difficult, but miraculously, without an alarm, she woke up before seven.

Today was the day Qi Jiao was going to the suburban morning market to stock up on flowers.

Last night after dinner, Chen Mian had casually asked about it, so she planned to drive to pick up and drop off Qi Jiao today.

When Chen Mian saw Qi Jiao, she shed tears.

Qi Jiao was at a loss and also somewhat afraid.

Later, after the two became familiar, Qi Jiao said: "I had no idea what you were trying to do."

Chen Mian didn't say she had come specifically to find her.

It was enough for her alone to remember those memories.

In fact, those memories would slowly fade as she lived her life in this world.

But that wasn't important.

What mattered was that she and Qi Jiao had reunited.

Chen Mian got up and washed her hair, applied light makeup, originally planning to wear a light-colored lipstick, but remembering that Qi Jiao said yesterday that maple leaf-colored lipstick was very pretty, she took out a maple leaf color from her makeup box and applied it.

Chen Mian, who wasn't used to wearing red tones, felt a bit uncomfortable looking at herself in the mirror.

However, she didn't have much time to deliberate, so she casually checked herself and drove out.

When she drove to the flower shop entrance, Qi Jiao was opening the door. Chen Mian walked over and said: "Let's go."

Qi Jiao looked confused: "Where to?"

"The morning market." Chen Mian said, "Aren't you going to stock up on flowers?"

Qi Jiao: "..."

Qi Jiao pointed at her own car, saying awkwardly: "I've already come back."

Chen Mian: "..."

Only then did Chen Mian learn that the morning market time was five or six o'clock.

And Qi Jiao was among the earlier batch—she'd already arrived at the morning market just after five, selecting the freshest and most beautiful flowers to bring back, then packaging them.

Chen Mian felt quite embarrassed.

But Chen Mian was someone who didn't really notice embarrassment. She just paused for two seconds before asking again: "Do you want to go eat breakfast?"

Qi Jiao looked at her: "Alright."

As long as she extended an invitation, Qi Jiao would put down all her work to accompany her for breakfast.

After eating breakfast, Chen Mian followed Qi Jiao to the flower shop.

Actually, to Qi Jiao, this was somewhat strange, and anyone else would find it strange too.

Because this was only the third day they'd known each other.

Chen Mian followed Qi Jiao around almost inseparably.

Inviting her to take walks, inviting her to dinner.

What was even stranger was that Qi Jiao agreed to everything.

These past few days, Qi Jiao couldn't forget that first glance when she saw Chen Mian—her heart racing, her eyes inexplicably moist, wanting to rush toward her, and those tearful eyes that kept appearing in her dreams that night.

Intuition told her that those eyes shouldn't be like that.

They should be cold, indifferent, disdainful.

Yet she could see endless affection beyond those emotions.

Even the fact that Chen Mian drove to her flower shop entrance early in the morning saying she'd take her to the morning market didn't seem strange to Qi Jiao.

Because this was exactly the kind of thing Chen Mian would do.